



DIGITAL **TRANSFORMATION** *(of est. businesses)*

Prof. Thales Teixeira

Fall 2025

In a nutshell, the two courses that I teach.

Digital Disruption.

(Winter 25, 26) Understanding and building digital disruption.



startup p.o.v.

Digital Transformation.

(Fall 25) Understanding and executing a digital transformation (this course)



incumbent p.o.v.

Who should take this course

Students interested in careers as:

- Consultants
- Corporate managers and executives
- HR managers for large organizations
- Heirs to family businesses
- PE investors and M&A counselors



Course description

- Digital Transformation is an advanced graduate course on all critical aspects for transforming a traditional “analog” incumbent into a digital organization.
- Students will learn how to (a) *identify weaknesses* of incumbents, (b) *propose business model innovations* to address those weaknesses, and (c) *plan for a transition* towards digitization of established companies facing the risk of disruption by startups and tech companies.



This is a case-based course. We will use Harvard cases in every class. Here is the list.

Responding to
Disruption



KOMATSU

Transforming
x to Digital

SIEMENS



moderna[®]

ticketmaster

Business Model
Transition



The New York Times



Structure of

Sessions

*Typical sessions will have
three components*

1. Harvard case
discussion

2. Interactive
presentation

3. Hands-on group
activity



Teaching philosophy of the course

In-depth learning

1. Harvard case discussion

Generalization

2. Interactive presentation

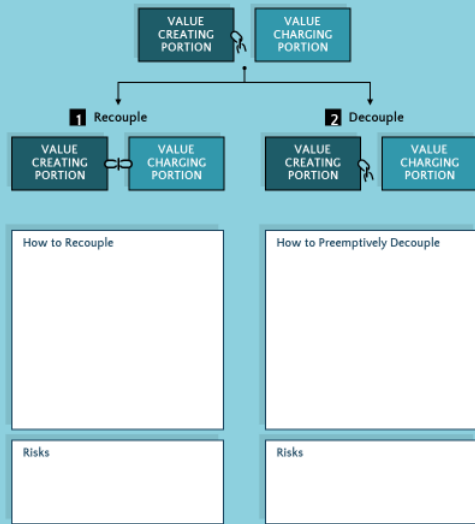
Fixation by practice

3. Hands-on group activity



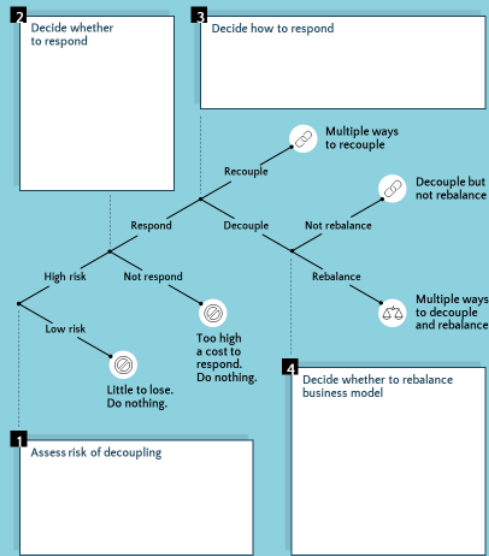
Exclusive FRAMEWORKS

TOOL Avenues of Response®



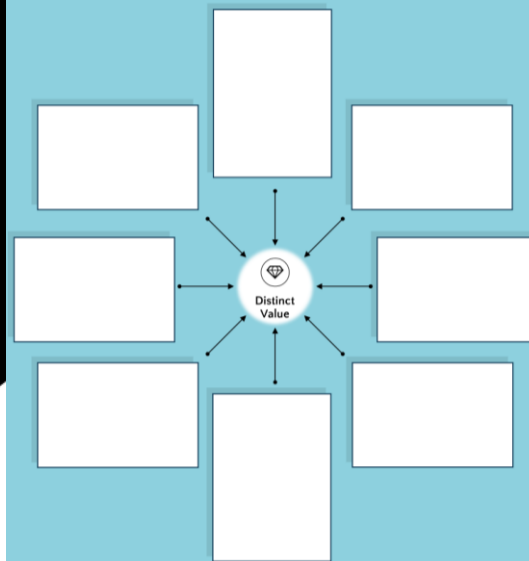
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TOOL Decision Response Tree®



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TOOL Value Driver Map®

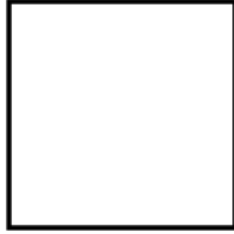
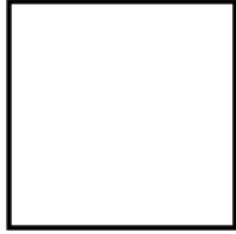


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Module



1



RESPONDING TO *DISRUPTION*



This is the tentative course reader contents.

Responding to Digital Disruption

1. **Case:** Best Buy
2. **Chapter or article:** none

Understanding Digital Disruption

1. **Case:** None.
2. **Chapter or article:** Chapter 1

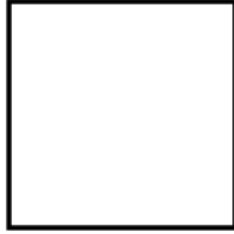
Value Creation, CVC

1. **Case:** Komatsu
2. **Chapter or article:** Chapter 3

Note: Check on Canvas for any updates prior to the class session.



Module



TRANSFORMING TO *DIGITAL*



This is the tentative course reader contents.

Digital Transformation Benefits

1. **Case:** Siemens
2. **Chapter or article:** NA

Connecting Digital Touchpoints

1. **Case:** Nissan
2. **Chapter or article:** NA

Becoming a Digital Factory

1. **Case:** Moderna
2. **Chapter or article:** NA

Maintaining Dominance

1. **Case:** Ticketmaster
2. **Chapter or article:** NA

Note: Check on Canvas for any updates prior to the class session.



MODULE

3



BUSINESS MODEL *TRANSITION*



This is the tentative course reader contents.

Transitioning to Subscriptions

1. **Case:** Adobe
2. **Chapter or article:** NA

Transitioning Business Model

1. **Case:** The New York Times Paywall
2. **Chapter or article:** Chapter 9

Transitioning Technologies

1. **Case:** Ferrari
2. **Chapter or article:** NA

Note: Check on Canvas for any updates prior to the class session.



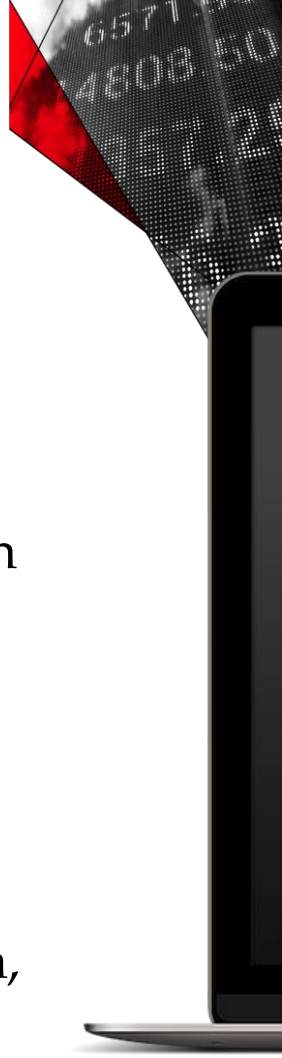
This is how you will be graded and here are my expectations of your conduct.

- Grading Breakdown

- *Class Participation (45%)*: Based on rigor and relevance of comment during case discussion.
- *Assignments (10%)*: Approximately 1 or 2.
- *Final project (45%)*: Analyze the digital transformation of an established business (in groups, not alone).

- Attendance and tardiness

- The course will be fully physical at the Rady School.
- If you need to leave during a session...
- Please no mobile phones to be used during case discussion, which will be approximately 80 to 90 minutes long.



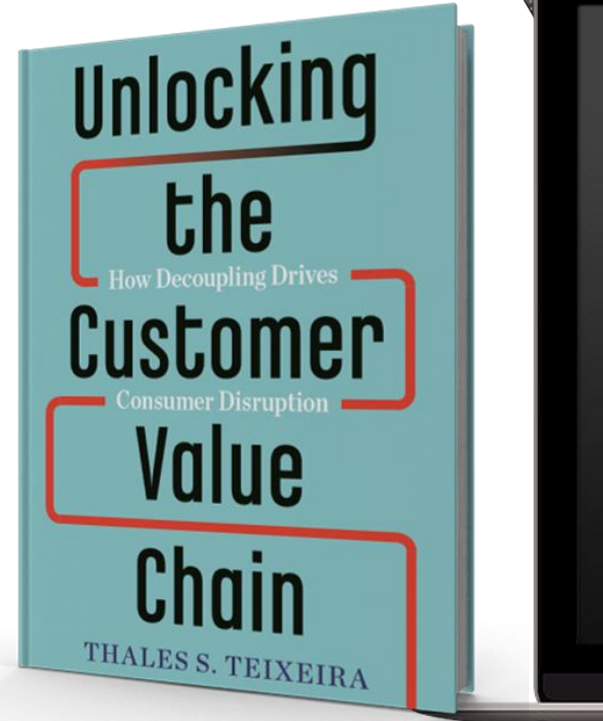
I strive to assign to my students only the critical readings of each session. The rest is optional.

Before class

- Harvard case study of the day
- Chapter of my textbook (or article, if any) will provide the supporting theory.

After class

- Slides will be posted on Canvas.



**Graded?
In class.**

Your typical week's work in DT.

Read case of the day

Required

No.

Answer assignment questions

Required

Yes.

**See if any question needs to be
handed in (few cases), do and
submit.**

Required

No.

If chapter or article, then read.

Required

**Final project
grade.**

If have time, work on final project.

Optional

No.

**If have time and interest, read
optional reading materials.**

Optional



Academic integrity

- Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind.
- The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at: <https://academicintegrity.ucsd.edu/process/policy.html>
- All aspects of the UCSD honor code apply in this course. If you are ever unsure how they apply, please ask your classmates, TA, or professor for clarification. It is much better to be conservative about honor code violations than to take a risk. You can be suspended or expelled for cheating.

Policy on AI, gen AI and LLMs

I will assume all students will have access to and use generative AI and LLMs (chatGPT and its clones chatPDF, LLama, Bard, etc.) as their own personal tutor. Anything incremental is their own work and will contribute to their grades. In practice I intend to use Chat GPT to feed my Harvard cases and ask it for summaries and to answer assignment questions about the case/company. I will tell that to students. And I may start class discussions with whatever the genAI tool spits out. That will be the baseline understanding. Any student that delivers in class or in homework at exactly that level will get a maximum grade of a C- or D. In other words, they just learned basic genAI prompts and to memorize the output. For work handed in, I ask students the courtesy to disclose gen AI as a source like any other source on the internet or otherwise.

IN SUM, I explicitly allow any use of large language models like ChatGPT or others. Be advised that their accuracy is often poor, so please be careful, as you remain solely responsible for the accuracy, content and conciseness of your submitted answers. I view LLMs as good sources of ideas and pointers, but poor sources of accurate information and VERY poor substitutes for human judgment.

[Guidance from the Academic Integrity office](#)

Students with disabilities

- A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.
- The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**
- Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or osd@ucsd.edu.

This is how you can contact me.

- Thales Teixeira

- tteixeira@ucsd.edu
- (920) 912-6796
- My office is offsite and at Rady (on a limited basis).

- Office Hours

- Email me and copy my assistant, Ciara Duggan (decoupling.assistant@gmail.com) to set up an appointment

- Canvas

- Main vehicle to communicate assignments with the class.
- I will also post Module Summary slides there as well.





PROF. THALES TEIXEIRA

I very much look
forward to meeting you
and working with you
to discuss, understand
and develop best
practices in Digital
Transformation.

To learn more about me:
www.decoupling.co